

Student Workbook

Heidi · Chapter 1: Going up to the Alm Uncle · Grade 3

Before You Read

FOCUS QUESTION

Have you ever had to go somewhere new where you did not know anyone? How did it feel? As you read, think about how Heidi might feel walking up the mountain to meet her grandfather for the first time.

Vocabulary

For each word: find it in the chapter, learn its meaning, and use it in a sentence.

meadows

"This path goes through woods and meadows until it gets steep and the air fills with the sweet scent of herbs." (p. 1)

Meaning: Large, open fields covered in grass and wildflowers.

Example: We ran through the green meadows and picked wildflowers on our walk.

shawl

"She was wearing several layers of clothes and a big red shawl, despite the summer heat." (p. 1)

Meaning: A large piece of cloth worn over your shoulders or head to keep warm.

Example: Grandma wrapped a warm shawl around her shoulders on the cold night.

gossip

inherited

"People just gossip, but nobody knows much about him." (p. 5)

Meaning: Talking about other people's lives in a way that may not be true or kind.

Example: It is not nice to gossip about your classmates at school.

"Uncle had inherited a big farm." (p. 5)

Meaning: Received something, like money or land, from a family member after they died.

Example: She inherited her grandmother's old ring after she passed away.

graze

"Every day, Peter would collect the goats from his village and lead them up the mountain to graze." (p. 9)

Meaning: When animals eat grass or plants growing on the ground.

Example: The cows went out to graze in the field all morning.

nimble

"She now felt as nimble as the goats themselves." (p. 9)

Meaning: Able to move quickly and easily without falling or slipping.

Example: The nimble cat jumped from rock to rock without any trouble.

steep

"This path goes through woods and meadows until it gets steep and the air fills with the sweet scent of herbs." (p. 1)

Meaning: A hill or path that goes up very sharply and is hard to climb.

Example: My legs were tired after walking up the steep hill.

carpentry

"Tobias trained as a carpenter in a place called Mels." (p. 7)

Meaning: The skill of building things out of wood, like houses or furniture.

Example: My uncle learned carpentry and built a wooden table for our kitchen.

gruff

"What does that mean?" asked the old man with a gruff voice." (p. 13)

Meaning: A voice that sounds rough, low, and a little unfriendly.

Example: The gruff old dog barked loudly when we walked by the gate.

attire

"When Peter noticed Heidi in her simple attire, a huge grin spread across his face." (p. 9)

Meaning: The clothes that someone is wearing.

Example: She wore her best attire to the school picture day.

Basic Comprehension

Answer these questions using evidence from the chapter.

1. What is the name of the little girl in this chapter, and how old is she?

2. Where is Deta taking Heidi at the start of the chapter?

3. Why does Deta say she cannot keep taking care of Heidi?

4. What does Heidi do with her heavy clothes and shoes while climbing the mountain?

5. What does Deta give Peter so he will go back down the hill and get Heidi's clothes?

6. What does Heidi say when she first meets her grandfather at his hut?

Reading Between the Lines

These questions require you to make inferences — think carefully!

1. Heidi took off her heavy clothes and shoes without asking Deta. What does this tell you about what kind of person Heidi is?
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2. Barbara says she would not want to live with Alm-Uncle and that Heidi will not be happy there. Why do you think Barbara feels this way? Use details from the chapter to help explain your answer.
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3. When Heidi greeted her grandfather, "the old man looked up at the sound of her voice, his face softening into a smile." Why do you think his face softened when he saw Heidi, even though he seemed grumpy?
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Analysis Questions

Dig deeper into character, theme, or the author's craft.

1. Deta and Alm-Uncle both seem to want someone else to take care of Heidi. How are their reasons different? Use details from the chapter to explain.
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2. The author describes the mountain path as having "the sweet scent of herbs" and a "breathtaking" view of the valley. Why do you think the author describes the mountain this way at the start of the story?
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3. Think about what we learn about Alm-Uncle's life from the stories Deta tells Barbara. Does knowing his past help you understand why he lives alone on the mountain? Explain using details from the chapter.
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Multiple Choice

1. Why does Deta need to leave Heidi with Alm-Uncle?
- A. She is tired of climbing the mountain every day.
 - B. She has been offered a job in Frankfurt and cannot take Heidi with her.
 - C. Alm-Uncle asked Deta to bring Heidi to live with him.
 - D. Heidi asked to go and live with her grandfather.
2. How does Peter get Heidi's clothes and shoes from down the hill?
- A. He carries them up on his own because he wants to help.
 - B. One of the goats brings them up the hill.
 - C. Deta gives him a five-penny coin and he runs down and gets them.
 - D. Heidi goes back down the hill to get them herself.
3. Where does Alm-Uncle sit when Heidi, Deta, and Peter arrive at his hut?
- A. Inside the hut by the fire.
 - B. On a bench by the side of the hut, overlooking the valley.
 - C. Behind the three large fir trees at the back of the hut.
 - D. On top of the rocky ground behind the hut.

Short Answer

Use a specific page number to support your answer.

1. What do we learn about Peter's daily job on the mountain? Use a detail from the chapter and include the page number.

2. What happened to Heidi's parents, Tobias and Adelheid? Use details from the chapter and include the page number.

3. How does Alm-Uncle react when Deta tells him it is his turn to look after Heidi? Use a detail from the chapter and include the page number.

Creative Response

Imagine you are Heidi. You have just arrived at your grandfather's hut high up on the mountain. Write a short diary entry telling what you saw, heard, and felt on your first day there. Use details from the chapter to help you!

- Hint 1: Think about what Heidi saw when she got to the top — the hut, the fir trees, the valley below, and the goats. Describe at least one thing she saw.
- Hint 2: Think about how Heidi felt meeting her grandfather for the first time. Was she scared, excited, or curious? Use a feeling word in your writing.
- Hint 3: Start your diary entry with "Dear Diary," and try to write at least three sentences about Heidi's day.

Chapter Timeline

Put these events in the correct order they happened in the chapter.

1. Deta and Heidi walk up the mountain path from Maienfeld. Deta's friend Barbara joins them.
2. Heidi lets go of Deta's hand and sits on the ground because she is hot.
3. Heidi wanders off and joins Peter the goat herder and his goats on the mountainside.
4. Heidi takes off her heavy shoes, socks, shawl, and extra dress so she can move more freely.
5. Deta gives Peter a five-penny coin to go back down and get Heidi's pile of clothes.
6. Heidi, Deta, and Peter reach Alm-Uncle's hut at the top of the mountain.
7. Heidi greets her grandfather and Deta tells him it is now his turn to look after Heidi.

Thinking Deeper

Based on what happened in this chapter, I predict that Heidi and her grandfather will _____ because in the chapter I read that _____.